WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

TURKS AND CAICOS ISLANDS

Americas

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Providenciales and Grace Bay	Commercial and tourism centre of this British Overseas Territory; new openings in 2026 include Hotel Indigo and the 184-room Andaz, with St. Regis and Janu (2027) in the pipeline	Luxury hospitality, branded residences, retail and professional services
Grand Turk	Capital and seat of government; the Grand Turk Cruise Center handled over one million passengers in 2025	Cruise tourism, heritage tourism, public services
Howard Hamilton International Airport (Providenciales)	Main air gateway, being upgraded under a government-funded, phased National Aviation Infrastructure Programme of up to $30 million, including a new 30,000–40,000 sq ft arrivals hall	Aviation infrastructure, construction, airport services
South Dock and national ports	Principal cargo gateway; $54 million is committed to South Dock phases 1 and 2, with a further $30 million in 2026/27 for phases 3 and 4 and $22 million for a fuel discharge mooring system	Port logistics, marine construction, fuel and supply chains
South Caicos	Emerging tourism island with a new airport terminal and port upgrades funded in the 2026/27 budget	Boutique resorts, marine tourism, fisheries
North Caicos, Middle Caicos and Salt Cay	Less developed Family Islands where the investment threshold for a Permanent Residence Certificate is lower ($750,000 versus $1.5 million on Providenciales), with runway upgrades planned on North Caicos	Eco-tourism, residential development, agriculture
Real estate market (island-wide)	Foreign individuals may buy property without restriction, and development agreements worth $1.27 billion cover over 1,000 new hotel rooms	Resort and residential real estate, construction

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Invest Turks and Caicos (Invest TCI), the investment promotion agency operating under the Encouragement of Development Ordinance and the National Investment Policy revised in December 2023, advises on customs duty and stamp duty concessions, permits and post-establishment support

- Development Agreements leading to Development Orders, the usual route for concessions on larger projects, subject to Invest TCI due diligence and with Immigration Protocol Documents to streamline expatriate work permits
- No corporate, income, capital gains, withholding or wealth taxes; government revenue comes mainly from accommodation tax, import duties, stamp duty and work permit fees
- US dollar as the official currency, with no central bank and no exchange controls, allowing straightforward movement of capital and profits
- English-influenced common-law legal system with the Privy Council in London as the final court of appeal, and no general legislation restricting foreign direct investment
- Business licensing under the Business Licensing Act, with most sectors open and certain categories reserved for majority Islander ownership; a revised framework (Exclusive, Reserved at 60% Islander ownership, Restricted and General) went to public consultation in March 2026
- Permanent Residence Certificate by investment for qualifying investments of $750,000 in the Family Islands or $1.5 million on Providenciales, with at least 60% of employees Turks and Caicos Islanders

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

The Turks and Caicos Islands in October 2026 combine one of the Caribbean's strongest growth records with an exceptionally strong public balance sheet. Real GDP grew 5.6% in 2024 after three years of double-digit expansion, and the 2026/27 budget forecasts growth of 3–4% in 2026 and around 4% a year through 2029, with GDP per capita of about $36,400. Tourism set records in 2025, with 640,754 stayover visitors and around 1.3 million cruise passengers, and stayover arrivals rose a further 6% to 384,590 in the first half of 2026. S&P upgraded the territory to A- in February 2025 and affirmed the rating in February 2026. Public debt stood at just $288,000 at the end of May 2026, against cash balances of $420.8 million and a National Wealth Fund of $97.5 million, while development agreements worth $1.27 billion are set to add over 1,000 hotel rooms and 2,000 permanent jobs.

The islands' main structural feature is their concentration on tourism, which accounts indirectly for about 65% of GDP, with over 90% of visitors coming from the United States, together with exposure to Atlantic hurricanes. The territory has built strong buffers against both. Cash reserves equal to roughly 23% of GDP meant that Hurricane Irma in 2017 had a limited fiscal impact, and Hurricane Melissa in October 2025 caused no significant damage, with airports reopening the day after closure. The government is broadening the economic base through new airlift, including United's Denver service from December 2026 and BermudAir routes from six US airports, along with port and airport upgrades. It also plans to borrow on capital markets for infrastructure, digitisation, solid waste and housing, using its credit rating to fund the next phase of growth.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Concentration on tourism and the US market	Tourism drives about 65% of GDP indirectly and over 90% of visitors come from the US, so revenues track US travel demand	Demand has proved robust, with record arrivals in 2025 and 2026; diversified airlift and luxury positioning support resilience, and investors can stress-test occupancy assumptions
Hurricane exposure	The islands lie in the Atlantic hurricane belt, with the season running to 30 November	Strong government cash buffers, resilient building standards and comprehensive insurance cover limit disruption, as shown by the quick reopening after Hurricane Melissa in 2025
Local-ownership rules in reserved business categories	Some sectors, such as real estate agencies and retail, require majority Islander ownership, and a revised licensing framework was under consultation in 2026	Most sectors remain open to full foreign ownership; investors can partner with Islander-owned firms and should confirm the final categories with Invest TCI and the Inland Revenue Department

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Labour availability and work permits	Work permits are generally annual and require evidence that skills are not available locally; since April 2026, employers must arrange private overseas medical cover for permit holders	Development Agreements and Immigration Protocol Documents streamline staffing; local training and hiring build long-term workforce capacity
Property transaction costs	Stamp duty on land transfers ranges from 5% to 10%, and land-transaction receipts were 40% lower year-on-year in April–May 2026	Duty concessions are available through Invest TCI for qualifying projects, and the absence of income and capital gains taxes improves overall returns
Public safety perceptions and firearms law	The US travel advisory has stood at Level 2 since 2023, and possession of firearms or ammunition is a criminal offence	Murders fell from 47 in 2024 to 27 in 2025, with none recorded between September 2025 and May 2026, according to the Premier; staff and guests can be briefed on firearms rules
Airport and infrastructure capacity	The airport public-private partnership was cancelled in December 2025 in favour of a phased, government-funded programme	Faster, practical upgrades and port works create construction and services opportunities, and a larger terminal remains a long-term goal

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

The Turks and Caicos Islands present a low-debt, high-income risk profile underpinned by an A- rating from S&P, near-zero public debt, cash balances above $420 million and a National Wealth Fund approaching $100 million. As a British Overseas Territory, the islands benefit from the stability of UK oversight: the Governor is responsible for security, external affairs, law and order, and key aspects of public finance, and S&P views these ties as a positive factor for stability. UK and UN sanctions apply automatically, so investors should apply standard sanctions and AML screening. The main sensitivities are dependence on US tourism and hurricane exposure, both mitigated by strong fiscal buffers and a track record of quick recovery. Investors should also follow the 2026 business-licensing reform, which may change ownership rules in some local-service categories, and note that there is currently no data protection law or merger control regime. Fully dollarised and free of exchange controls, the islands carry no currency or repatriation risk for US-dollar investors.

MARKET ACCESS

The Turks and Caicos Islands have been an associate member of CARICOM since 2 July 1991. They benefit from duty-free access to Canada under CARIBCAN for goods produced in the islands, and from the UK's commitment of 9 November 2020 to keep tariff-free access for goods originating in the territory after Brexit. The economy is services-led, and its main external market is the United States, which supplies over 90% of visitors. Nonstop flights link Providenciales with Miami, Fort Lauderdale, New York, Boston, Atlanta, Charlotte and Philadelphia, and United's Denver route from December 2026 and BermudAir's six-airport expansion from October 2026 will widen that reach. Grand Turk is an established cruise port, with roughly 350–400 ship calls scheduled for 2026. The US dollar currency and English-language common-law system make the islands a straightforward base for North American and European investors.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the Premier and Ministry of Finance, Economic Development, Investment and Trade (Premier C. Washington Misick)	Sets economic, fiscal and investment policy, including the 2026/27 budget, planned capital-market borrowing and business-licensing reform	Primary reference point for strategic direction and major project approvals
Governor's Office (Governor Dileeni Daniel-Selvaratnam)	Represents the UK and is responsible for security, external affairs, law and order, and key aspects of public finance	Relevant for governance, security and UK-linked matters
Invest Turks and Caicos (Invest TCI)	Investment promotion agency that advises on concessions, Development	Standard first point of contact for market entry and incentive negotiations

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
	Agreements, work permits and Permanent Residence Certificates	
Turks and Caicos Islands Financial Services Commission	Financial-sector regulator in a fully dollarised economy without a central bank	Relevant for banking, insurance and corporate-services matters
Ministry of Tourism (Minister Zhavargo Jolly) and Experience Turks and Caicos	Lead tourism policy and destination marketing, including airlift and new-market development	Key partners for hospitality and airlift-related investment
Turks and Caicos Islands Airports Authority	Operates the islands' airports, where phased upgrades are under way at Providenciales, Grand Turk, South Caicos and North Caicos	Counterpart for aviation, construction and airport-services opportunities
Ministry of Physical Planning and Infrastructure Development (Minister Arlington Musgrove)	Oversees planning approvals and public infrastructure, including roads and ports	Essential for development permissions and infrastructure partnerships

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

Invest TCI is the main gateway for investors, offering free, confidential advisory services from offices in Providenciales and Grand Turk and referrals to vetted local service providers. The Turks and Caicos Hotel and Tourism Association, a member of the Caribbean Hotel and Tourism Association, is the leading industry body for hospitality investors, and Experience Turks and Caicos, the destination marketing organisation, works closely with airlines and resort operators. The Caribbean Development Bank is the territory's established development lender. Locally qualified law firms and the major international hotel brands active on Grace Bay are useful sources of practical intelligence on development agreements, licensing and labour.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

The Turks and Caicos Islands best suit hospitality and real estate investors targeting the luxury segment, where record arrivals, new airlift and $1.27 billion of development agreements point to sustained demand. Branded residence developers and high-net-worth individuals can benefit from unrestricted foreign property ownership and residence-by-investment options, while construction, engineering and aviation-services firms can pursue opportunities in the airport and port programmes. Infrastructure, utilities and digital investors may find openings as the government finances projects in fibre, solid waste and housing. The territory is less suited to manufacturing or export-led strategies, given its small domestic market and import-dependent cost base.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage Invest TCI early on concessions and Development Agreements
Open dialogue with Invest Turks and Caicos to scope customs and stamp duty concessions, due diligence requirements and the Development Agreement route for larger projects.

STEP 2: Confirm business-licence category and ownership structure
Check the activity against the revised business-licence categories with the Inland Revenue Department, and structure Islander partnerships where a reserved category applies.

STEP 3: Plan staffing and immigration requirements
Secure Immigration Protocol Documents and budget for work permit fees and private medical cover for permit holders, alongside local training and hiring commitments.

STEP 4: Build hurricane resilience and insurance into project design
Apply resilient building standards, comprehensive property and business-interruption cover, and seasonal operating plans for the June–November hurricane season.

STEP 5: Position for the public infrastructure programme
Track airport, port, fibre, solid waste and housing projects, including those funded through the government's planned capital-market borrowing, for construction and services partnerships.